

mail of the week

A Living Death

The protests for justice in Rizwanur Rahman's case as well as against Nandigram's land deal are an indication of the increasing awakening among the people against the brutal grip of the communists in West Bengal ("Battle for Justice", October 29).

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

The entire country today is suffering from inconclusive investigations and elusive justice. Unleashing tyranny and violence upon all those who defy the social, cultural and religious "norms" is a tradition here.

Needed Afford-ability

All the gadgets that the magazine featured were worth buying but the exorbitant prices always tend to play spoilsport ("What's Hot", October 29). It would help if these products were available at affordable prices to discourage piracy.

MAHESH KUMAR, Delhi

The Greensmiths

Thanks to the efforts of Al Gore and IPCC led by R.K. Pachauri, global warming and climate change are now getting their due attention ("Earth's Warriors", October 29). Global warming has indeed become a noble cause.

MEGHANA. A., Hyderabad

Terminate Terror

Fear of terror has now overwhelmed the country ("Theatre of Terror", October 29). Is this the freedom for which our forefathers fought relent-

lessly, since fear is the anti-thesis of liberty?

K. PRADEEP, Chennai

Give Jobs, Not Sops

The Government's sops spree reminds one of the great philosopher Voltaire who once famously remarked, "When you give alms to the poor, you keep them alive today so that they can beg tomorrow" ("Season of Sops", October 22). Instead of giving them alms, the Government should

improve the economy through industrialisation and provide them a living.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, Kolkata

Check the Chinese

We are yet to learn from history ("Creeping Aggression", October 15). Despite the Sino-Indian war in 1962, the South Block is hell bent on repeating Nehru's mistake by taking Chinese incursions into our territory casually.

V.G. PARANJPE, Pune

RIISING AGGRESSION



Rising aspirations, increasing inequalities and the media's penchant for exposing wrong are the key to growing resentment towards the law which culminates in mob violence ("Mob Rule", October 29).

G.B. BAGAI, on e-mail

It is worth noting that mob anger is directed not at the culprits, but at the system. If the system fails, mob acts will only rise.

PARIMAL RAJKUNTWAR, on e-mail

Mob violence is nothing but sub human behaviour and a symptom of decaying civilisation.

MANJUNATH H. BASAPPA, Bangalore

The Government's knee-jerk measures only act as oxygen to this deep-rooted disease called mob rule.

SHAILENDRA SAXENA, on e-mail

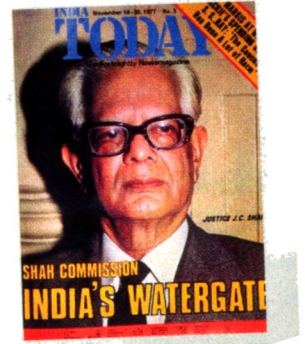
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Years Ago in India Today

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Useless Commission

What real purpose will the findings of the Shah Commission serve? Is it not a waste of time and resources to dig out the past happenings? Why does the Janata Government not apply itself to economic and other basic issues related to the primary needs of the people?

Is not the Shah Commission on a divisory path? Those



J.C. Shah and similar other questions are being posed by the man on the street. And those who favour the Shah Commission answer back rather defensively: "Sensitive matters of public importance," they say, "if left to agencies for routine inquiries can create needless controversies and generate an atmosphere of suspicion." At its worst, the Shah Commission provides material for after-dinner conversation. Many are not clear as to what exactly is the practical use of "establishing truth".

—Devdutt

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